



Ethicare
Resourcing

NEW ZEALAND RESOURCE CENTRE · COMPANION CHECKLIST

Physiotherapy (PBNZ) Registration Checklist

A practical, tickable checklist to work through alongside your Physiotherapy Board of New Zealand Registration Guide — so nothing gets missed on the way to registration.



Before you begin

Tick as you go

Tick each box on screen as you complete it. The items are grouped into stages, roughly in the order you'll tackle them — but you can work on several at once. This checklist is a companion to the main guide, which explains the *why* behind each step. It complements, and does not replace, the official guidance of the Physiotherapy Board of New Zealand, who make all registration decisions.

01 Before you start

Get oriented before you spend money or gather documents.

- ☐ **Confirm which registration pathway is yours**
Express (UK/Ireland/Canada/South Africa), TTMR (AHPRA Australia), or General (everyone else)
- ☐ **Read the Physiotherapy Practice Thresholds**
The Australia–NZ competencies your whole application is assessed against
- ☐ **Note that you'll register in the General Scope**
Advanced Practice and Specialist scopes come later, after NZ experience
- ☐ **Check recency-of-practice requirements**
Flag any significant break from practice early — a Return to Practice process may apply
- ☐ **Note the current fees**
Check the Board's live fees schedule — figures change periodically

02 Cultural competency (start early!)

Two courses required — entirely within your control, so do them ahead of time.

- ☐ **Complete a Mauri Ora course**
e.g. Foundations in Cultural Competency — counts as one of your two
- ☐ **Complete a second, distinct course**
e.g. Healthcare and the Treaty of Waitangi (Mauri Ora), OR Ngā Paerewa Modules 1+2
- ☐ **Note: Ngā Paerewa Modules 1 AND 2 = ONE course only**
Both modules together count as a single course — pair it with a Mauri Ora course
- ☐ **Save all completion certificates**
You'll upload these with your application

03 Identity & qualification documents

The foundations every application needs.

- ☐ **Passport OR birth certificate**
Either is accepted for identity; full clear colour scan
- ☐ **Name change document(s)**
Only if your name differs across documents
- ☐ **Primary physiotherapy degree**
Certified copy of your qualifying qualification
- ☐ **Academic transcript**
Required alongside the degree
- ☐ **Curriculum**
Required on the General Pathway — often forgotten
- ☐ **Clinical Hours Profile**
Required on the General Pathway — often forgotten
- ☐ **Certification done correctly**
Each document certified, OR sent to the Board directly by the issuing authority
- ☐ **Translations (if applicable)**
Certified translation of any non-English documents

04 Registration & good standing

Confirmation you're in good professional standing — mind the 3-month rule.

- ☐ **Evidence of registration (Express / TTMR)**
Degree/transcript from UK/Ireland/Canada/SA, or proof of registration (HCPC, CORU, HPCSA, Canadian regulator, or AHPRA)
- ☐ **Certificate(s) of Good Standing (COGS)**
From every physiotherapy regulator you've registered with
- ☐ **COGS less than 3 months old at submission**
A hard PBNZ rule — don't request them too early
- ☐ **Police / criminal history certificates**
From every country lived in 12+ months in the last 10 years since age 18
- ☐ **Police certificates less than 3 months old at submission**
Same 3-month rule applies — balance against how long they take to obtain

05 Experience & English

Proof your skills and communication are current.

- ☐ **CV on the PBNZ template**
Use the Board's own template — not your own format — with every period accounted for
- ☐ **Confirm which English pathway applies**
First-language evidence, English-medium education, or a test
- ☐ **Sit IELTS (Academic) or OET if required**
Meet the minimum in every component, not just overall
- ☐ **Check English test validity dates**
Results expire (typically ~2 years) — time it to stay valid through assessment

06 Competency evidence — Phase 3 (General Pathway)

Only if your curriculum doesn't cover every competency.

- ☐ **Review the assessor's competency request**
Lists exactly which competencies still need demonstrating
- ☐ **Read the Board's supporting-evidence guidance**
Use the Board's guidance document and templates (Reflections, Validation of Work History)
- ☐ **Gather specific examples for each competency**
Detailed evidence from your training or work — already-met ones don't need repeating
- ☐ **Submit within 3 months of the request**
Name files clearly; keep folders short and well-organised

07 Submitting your application

Putting it all together — cleanly.

- ☐ **Create your application on MyPBNZ**
Work through each section carefully and accurately
- ☐ **Answer the fitness-for-registration questions**
English, physical/mental fitness, professional conduct — full, honest disclosure
- ☐ **Upload documents as clean colour scans**
Straight, square, nothing cut off, clearly named — present it like a portfolio
- ☐ **Pay the applicable fee**
Keep your payment confirmation
- ☐ **Final check, then submit**
Could a stranger find everything they need without emailing you?

08 After you submit

Keep things moving to your decision.

- ☐ **Watch for Board communication**
Check email (including spam) and your MyPBNZ portal regularly
- ☐ **Respond to any requests promptly**
Speed of response is the biggest factor within your control
- ☐ **Registration confirmed by the Registrar**
You're registered in the General Scope; HPI number issued
- ☐ **Apply for your Annual Practising Certificate (APC)**
Via MyPBNZ, before you can practise — APC year runs to 31 March; costs reimbursed in an Ethicare package

HOW ETHICARE WILL SUPPORT YOU

You don't have to do this alone

If anything on this checklist raises a question, that's exactly what we're here for. We support and guide you through every stage — from first enquiry to starting work. The registration decision always rests with the Physiotherapy Board of New Zealand.

READY TO BEGIN?

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This checklist is provided for general information to support internationally qualified professionals and complements, but does not replace, the official guidance of the Physiotherapy Board of New Zealand. All registration requirements and decisions rest with the Board. Requirements can change — always check the Board's current published guidance before acting.



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